

PROJECT PLAN - DEFINE PHASE

Order Processing Efficiency Improvement Project | 16-Week DMAIC Timeline

1. PROJECT TIMELINE OVERVIEW

Total Project Duration: 16 weeks (4 months)

Project Start Date: December 2, 2025

Projected Completion: March 31, 2026

Define Phase (Current): Weeks 1-3 (Dec 2 - Dec 20, 2025)

2. PHASE SCHEDULE & MILESTONES

Phase	Timeline	Duration	Key Activities	Deliverables	Success Criteria / Milestone
DEFINE	Dec 2-20, 2025 (Weeks 1-3)	3 weeks	- Project charter development - Stakeholder analysis - Customer requirements (CTS) - High-level process mapping (SIPOC) - Communication planning	- Charter (approved) - Stakeholder analysis - CTS summary - SIPOC diagram - Communication plan	✓ Charter approved by sponsor ✓ All stakeholders engaged ✓ Customer requirements defined ✓ Ready for Measure Phase
MEASURE	Dec 23, 2025 - Jan 31, 2026 (Weeks 4-6)	3 weeks	- Current state process mapping (detailed) - Baseline data collection - Measurement system validation (MSA) - Process capability analysis - Bottleneck identification	- Detailed process map - Baseline metrics report - Process performance data - Data collection plan - Measurement system analysis	✓ Baseline metrics validated ✓ Measurement system adequate ✓ Process capability determined ✓ Bottlenecks identified
ANALYZE	Feb 3 - Feb 28, 2026 (Weeks 7-9)	3 weeks	- Root cause analysis - Fishbone / Pareto analysis - Hypothesis testing - Statistical analysis - Problem ranking	- Root cause analysis report - Pareto charts - Statistical analysis - Problem prioritization matrix - Hypothesis test results	✓ Root causes identified & validated ✓ Vital few problems prioritized ✓ Hypotheses tested statistically
IMPROVE	Mar 3 - Mar 24, 2026 (Weeks 10-14)	5 weeks	- Solution design & brainstorming - Pilot test planning - Solution implementation (pilot) - Results analysis - Full implementation planning	- Solution design document - Pilot test results - Implementation plan - Process documentation - ROI analysis	✓ Solutions designed & tested ✓ Pilot results meet targets ✓ Implementation plan ready
CONTROL	Mar 24 - Mar 31, 2026 (Weeks 15-16)	2 weeks	- Full implementation - Control plan development - Staff training & certification - Documentation & process locking - Project closure	- Control plan - Training materials - Process documentation - Dashboard/scorecards - Project closure report	✓ Full implementation complete ✓ Staff trained & certified ✓ Controls in place ✓ Sustained results verified

3. DETAILED DEFINE PHASE SCHEDULE (WEEKS 1-3)

Week	Activity	Responsible	Status / Output	Dependencies
Week 1 Dec 2-6	1. Project kickoff meeting	Black Belt PM	Team alignment, roles clarified	None
	2. Charter development (draft)	Black Belt + Green Belt	Draft charter complete	Sponsor input required
	3. Stakeholder 1-on-1 interviews (first 4)	Black Belt	4 interviews completed	Stakeholder availability
	4. CTS customer interviews (first 3)	Green Belt	3 VOC interviews captured	Customer contact list
	5. Charter finalization & sponsor approval	Black Belt + Sponsor	Charter signed off	Charter draft complete

Week 2 Dec 9-13	6. Stakeholder interviews (remaining 4)	Black Belt	All 8 stakeholder 1-on-1s done	Stakeholder scheduling
	7. CTS customer interviews (final 2)	Green Belt	All 5 customer interviews done	Customer availability
	8. SIPOC diagram creation	Green Belt + Warehouse Mgr	SIPOC draft complete	Process subject matter expert
Week 3 Dec 16-20	9. CTS summary finalization	Green Belt	CTS summary with metrics	Customer VOC data complete
	10. Steering committee meeting (DEFINE PHASE REVIEW)	Black Belt + Sponsor	Charter approved, resources confirmed	Charter finalized, stakeholder analysis done
	11. All-hands warehouse briefing	Warehouse Manager + Black Belt	Staff informed, Q&A conducted	Charter approved, messaging ready

4. RESOURCE ALLOCATION SUMMARY

Role	Name	% Allocation	Key Responsibilities
Black Belt / Project Manager	TBD	40%	Overall project leadership, timeline management
Green Belt (Lead)	TBD	20%	Data analysis, CTS development, documentation
Green Belt (Secondary)	TBD	20%	Data collection, process mapping support
Warehouse Manager	TBD	15%	Process expertise, staff coordination
IT Specialist	TBD	15%	System support, data access, technical planning
Executive Sponsor (VP Operations)	TBD	5%	Governance, approvals, escalations
Finance Representative	TBD	10%	Budget tracking, financial metrics

5. BUDGET ALLOCATION BY PHASE

Phase	Budget	Key Costs
Define	\$8,000 (11%)	Team time, software (Visio, etc.), customer interviews
Measure	\$12,000 (16%)	Data collection tools, analysis software, measurement system validation
Analyze	\$10,000 (13%)	Statistical analysis software, consultant support
Improve	\$35,000 (47%)	Pilot equipment, software configuration, system changes, implementation
Control	\$10,000 (13%)	Training development, staff time, documentation
TOTAL	\$75,000	Approved by Finance

6. KEY MILESTONES & DECISION GATES

Define Phase Gate (End of Week 3 - Dec 20):

- ✓ Charter signed by sponsor
- ✓ All stakeholders committed (75%+ at desired commitment level)
- ✓ CTS defined and validated with customers
- ✓ SIPOC completed
- ✓ **GO/NO-GO DECISION:** Proceed to Measure Phase